

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN LUXEMBOURG

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what happens to the land, water, and energy of Luxembourg, and a small commune's fight against a giant foreign data centre shows both how hard such a fight is and how it can be waged — even though, honestly, that fight is not yet won. When a global technology company set out to build a vast data centre at Bissen — a project that critics say could consume something like a tenth or more of the whole country's water supply for cooling, and as much electricity as every household in Luxembourg combined, in exchange for very few jobs, little tax, and almost no transparency — the community did not simply accept it. Local groups formed, the environmental movement pressed for answers, the mayor criticised the company's secrecy, and residents demanded to know what the project would really cost them in water and power. The government, eager for the investment, has favoured the company; the farmland was reclassified for industry, and a farmer who refused to sell was pressed until he gave way. The data centre is not built, but it is not stopped either: the fight is live, and its outcome is uncertain. What is certain is that a community refused to let a powerful company take its water and its land without a reckoning — and that communities elsewhere, facing the very same kind of project, have won.

The Luxembourg story teaches two things about stopping destructive projects here — including its honest limits, which this guide states plainly and up front, because the central one is large: this fight is not yet won. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever — the affected community, the documentation, the coalition, and the pressure on the deciders — pressed together. The second is distinctly modern, and it is the fight of this decade. **A community — even a small one, even against a powerful foreign technology company its own government courts — can use the project's real vulnerabilities (its enormous thirst for water and power, its thin public benefit, its secrecy) together with environmental law, transparency demands, public mobilisation, and local planning politics to delay, shrink, reshape, or stop a data centre or similar heavy development.** That combination — the water and energy exposure, the transparency demand, the law, the public, and the planning process — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it.

But the same story carries an honest warning this guide places first and takes seriously: **the Bissen fight has not been won.** The community has forced delays, demanded transparency, and kept the project contested — but the government still favours the company, the land is already reclassified, and the data centre may yet be built. This guide does not pretend otherwise. What lets it promise more than a doomed struggle is that communities in other countries, facing the same water-and-power-hungry data centres from the same kind of global companies, have won real victories — a court in one country revoked a project's permit over its water use and forced the company to start again without water cooling; campaigners in another forced a project to shrink and abandon water cooling; town after town in yet another simply refused the rezoning and sent the company away. Those are the proof that this fight is winnable, and the source of the levers this guide teaches. If your fight, too, is against a data centre or a heavy industrial project that threatens your water, your power, or your land — whether at Bissen or anywhere else in Luxembourg — this is the guide for it, clear-eyed that the local fight is still open and hard.

Most communities do not know HOW to make that power effective. They hear that a data centre is coming and assume "the government wants the investment and nothing can be done," and never demand the water and energy figures, never invoke the law, never organise. They generate private worry without organised opposition. The gap between projects reshaped and projects waved through is rarely apathy — Bissen proved a community will act. It is method: knowing how to expose the water and power cost, demand transparency, invoke the law, mobilise the public, and work the planning process.

This guide shows what actually works — inside the Luxembourg system as it is, and drawing on what has worked against these projects elsewhere. It is written for the person who has just heard that a data centre, a quarry, an incinerator, or another heavy development is coming to their commune, feels the familiar mix of alarm and helplessness, and wants to know whether anything can actually be done. The answer is yes — with the honest qualifier that the leading local example of this fight is still open, and that against a government set on an investment the realistic win is often a project delayed, shrunk, or reshaped rather than cleanly stopped. That qualifier is not a reason to despair; it is the reason to organise well, because the difference between a project waved through and one held to account is made by exactly the methods this guide sets out. Read it not as a promise of victory but as a map of the levers, drawn from where they have worked, so that your community fights with method rather than with hope alone.

The Strategic Framework

Effective campaigns follow the same underlying pattern, whether the goal is to stop a data centre, a quarry, an incinerator, or another destructive development:

STEP 1:	TARGET IDENTIFICATION	(find the project, the harm, and the deciders)
STEP 2:	DOCUMENTATION	(build the evidence -- water, energy, benefit)
STEP 3:	LOCAL OPPOSITION	(build the community and the coalition)
STEP 4:	LEGAL & REGULATORY	(water, energy, and the planning process)
STEP 5:	MEDIA STRATEGY	(make it a national and international cause)

These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. The water-and-energy evidence feeds the law, the media, and the public at once; the coalition grows; a transparency demand or a legal question is both pressure and a spur to the next. The community that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, is the one that wins what can be won — a project delayed, shrunk, reshaped, or stopped. The communities that beat these data centres elsewhere did exactly this, and Bissen's opponents are doing it now.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Luxembourg's — and a data centre's own weaknesses — give communities a distinctive set:

- **The water and energy exposure.** A data centre's **vast thirst for water and power** is its greatest vulnerability, as Bissen's water and energy figures became the heart of the opposition.
- **The transparency demand.** A company's **refusal to disclose** its water and energy use is itself a powerful line of attack, as the secrecy at Bissen was.
- **The thin public benefit. Few jobs, little tax, no scientific contribution** against real risks make the case easy to argue, as Bissen's critics found.
- **The law and the EU.** National and EU environmental, water, and energy law give real handles, as they did in the wins elsewhere.

- **The planning process and the commune.** Local land-use and communal politics are a real veto point, as Bissen's reclassification fight showed.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers guarantee a stop, or that Bissen is won. The government **favours the investment**; the land is **reclassified**; the outcome is **open**. This guide takes those limits seriously — it states them first and throughout — and shows you how to use the real, distinctive tools a data-centre fight offers — the water and energy exposure, the transparency demand, the thin benefit, the law, and the planning process — as communities have used them to win elsewhere, and as Bissen's opponents are using them now, even where the fight is not yet decided.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides your project's fate, at which level, and where along that path the project — or the leverage — is weakest. And map the water and energy the project will take and the transparency it refuses, because in Luxembourg a heavy development like a data centre is often best fought by exposing its true water and power cost, demanding the figures the company hides, and pressing the law, the commune, and the public.

The Levels of Decision

A Luxembourg development runs through several tracks at once, and each is a place to intervene.

The national government. The **government** courts foreign investment and — honestly — has **favoured the company** at Bissen; so it is a decider to be pressured and moved by public and legal cost, not relied upon.

The commune. The **commune and its land-use decisions** are a real veto point: a data centre needs land reclassified and permitted, and the communal council and the local politics around it can slow or block a project, as the Bissen reclassification was fought.

The environmental and utility regulators. The **environmental authorities, the water administration, and the energy system** must weigh a project's water and power demands, and can be pressed to demand better or refuse, as they have been elsewhere.

The courts. The **courts**, national and (through EU law) European, can **quash a permit** that ignored water or environmental law, as a court did in one of the wins abroad.

The public and the world. The **public, the press, and the international attention** to data centres' water and energy use are levers a community can use, as the global movement has.

The Journey of a Project

A typical data centre moves from a company's search for land and power, through a land reclassification and permits, toward construction and years of heavy water and energy use — with the **community's evidence, the commune, the regulators, the courts, and the public** able to intervene. **Every one of those stages is a door you can put your foot in**, and the water-and-energy exposure pressed on the regulators, the courts, and the public is the distinctive door here. The distinctive levers are the **water and energy exposure, the transparency demand, the thin benefit, the law, and the planning process**. Find out exactly where the project stands, and, crucially, **how much water and power it will really take, what the company refuses to disclose, and where the commune, the regulators, and the courts can intervene**,

because those are often where a project can be delayed, shrunk, or stopped.

Follow the Project, the Water, and the Deciders

Behind a project stand a proponent — often a powerful foreign company — and the government and commune that permit it. Trace who decides, who profits, and — importantly here — **how much water and energy the project will consume, what the company will not disclose, how thin the real public benefit is, and where the law and the planning process apply**. Two questions unlock most Luxembourg fights of this kind: **What is the project's true water and energy cost, and what is the company hiding?** and **Where — the commune, the regulators, the courts, the public — can that cost be turned into pressure?** The water-and-energy exposure and the transparency demand are, together, the heart of most such campaigns.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that can check the deciders, because they are levers too. The **commune and its council**; the **environmental authorities and the water administration**; the **energy regulator and the grid**; the **courts**, national and European; the **environmental movement** and civil-society groups; the **national press**; and the **international attention** that data centres now draw. In Luxembourg, the **water and energy exposure, the transparency demand, the thin benefit, the law, and the planning process** are the most distinctive levers. Each is a separate front, and a project shown to take a nation's water and power for little benefit, opposed by an organised community, pressed in law and at the commune, and exposed to the public rarely passes untouched — as data centres elsewhere have been delayed, shrunk, reshaped, and stopped, and as Bissen remains, for now, contested rather than built.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit months of effort, calibrate honestly — and here that means knowing the local fight is still open, even as the approach has won elsewhere. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how data-centre and comparable fights tend to go, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the community can **expose the true water and energy cost**, whether it can **force transparency**, whether the **law and the planning process** can be used, and whether **public and international attention** can be drawn. Where the water and power cost is large and provable, the levers here are strong, as the wins abroad show; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the government may favour the investment, that the company will fight, and that — as Bissen shows — the outcome can stay open for years.

Individual Step Success Rates

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	10–20%	weeks	low	Basis for every other step
Exposing water & energy cost	45–70%	weeks–months	low	The case at its most powerful
Forcing transparency	40–65%	months	low	The figures the company hid
Legal & planning challenge	35–60%	months–years	moderate	A permit quashed; a project delayed

1. **The water and energy exposure** — Luxembourg's foundation for these fights; the true, provable cost that makes the case, as it did at Bissen.
2. **The transparency demand** — the distinctive lever; a company's refusal to disclose is itself a weapon.
3. **The law and the planning process** — the courts, the regulators, and the commune that can delay or refuse.
4. **The public and the media** — the mobilisation that turns cost into pressure.
5. **The thin benefit** — the argument that unites a community against a project that gives little and takes much.

What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few patterns recur, at Bissen and in the wins abroad. **Water and energy cost is the killer argument** — a project that takes a nation's water and power for little benefit is hard to defend. **Transparency is a weapon** — a company that hides its figures looks like it has something to hide. **The law and the commune can bite** — permits get quashed and rezonings refused. **Thin benefit unites people** — few jobs and little tax against real risks is an easy case. **But governments court these investments** — and the fight can be long and its outcome open. The through-line: **expose the true water and energy cost; force transparency; argue the thin benefit; use the law and the commune; mobilise the public** — because a community that does can delay, shrink, reshape, and sometimes stop even a data centre a powerful company and a willing government want, as communities have done elsewhere and as Bissen's opponents are attempting now.

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective campaign begins by finding the exact project and harm that govern the threat — and the leverage the community holds, which here is often the water-and-energy cost and the transparency the company refuses. Vague opposition goes nowhere; a fight aimed at "the data centre that will take a tenth of the nation's water and as much power as every household, for a handful of jobs, whose figures the company will not disclose, and which the commune must reclassify land to allow" is a campaign — the kind being fought at Bissen. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

1. **What is the project's true water and energy cost?** This is the first question here. How much **water and power** will the project take, and how large is that against the nation's supply, as Bissen's figures were the heart of the fight.
2. **What is the company refusing to disclose?** What **water, energy, or environmental data** does the company hide, as the Bissen company refused its figures.
3. **How thin is the real public benefit?** How **few jobs, how little tax, how little else** does the project actually deliver against its risks.
4. **Where can the law and the planning process bite?** Which **environmental and water law, and which communal reclassification or permit**, can be challenged or refused, as the wins abroad and the Bissen reclassification show.

5. Who decides, who profits, and who is with us? Which company and officials are behind it, who profits, whether the government backs it — and which groups, experts, and communes will stand with the community.

A Worked Example

Suppose a foreign company plans a large data centre that will consume a major share of the local water and power for few jobs.

Working the five questions: **what is its true water and energy cost? What is the company hiding? How thin is the benefit? Where can the law and the commune bite?** And the deciders are the government, the commune, and the company, with the water-and-energy exposure, the transparency demand, the law, and the planning process as the pressure points.

Within a season you have moved from "the government wants the investment and nothing can be done" to a target list: expose the water and energy cost; force transparency; argue the thin benefit; use the law and the commune; mobilise the public. That is a campaign, not a complaint — and it is exactly how these projects have been beaten elsewhere. Notice what the five questions do: they convert a vague dread — a giant company is coming and the government wants it — into a set of specific, answerable targets, each with a lever attached. The water-and-energy cost is a number you can establish and publicise. The company's secrecy is a refusal you can challenge. The thin benefit is a claim you can test and puncture. The legal and planning handles are grounds you can assess with a lawyer. The deciders are people and bodies you can pressure. A dread has no handle; a target list has five. That translation, from helpless worry to a concrete plan, is the first and often the most important thing a campaign does, because it is what tells a discouraged community that there is, in fact, something to be done.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here, where a company hides its figures and a government favours the investment, hard numbers on water and energy are decisive. A regulator, a court, a journalist, and the public all move on evidence, not indignation — and in a data-centre fight, the true water and power cost, and the transparency the company refuses, are precisely what a campaign turns into pressure, so build them well and early. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Project, the Permits, and the Deciders

Get the facts the case turns on. Identify the **project, its owner, the land it needs, and the reclassification and permits it requires**; and establish **which authorities and communal decisions** apply, as the Bissen data centre needed farmland reclassified for industry. Establish the deciders and the project precisely — including, honestly, the government's backing — because they are what the evidence must move.

Layer 2: The Water, the Energy, and the Benefit

Document the reality the company would rather keep vague, and here the **water and energy figures are central**. Establish, from every available source and with expert help, the project's **water consumption** (and what share of the local or national supply that is), its **energy demand** (and what share of the grid or of national household use), and its **real public benefit** — the actual jobs, tax, and other value against the risks. Record what the company **refuses to disclose**, because that refusal is itself evidence. At Bissen, the estimates that the data centre could take a large share of the country's water and as much power as all its

households, set against very few jobs, were the case. Photographs, figures, expert analyses, and the record of the company's secrecy make the harm undeniable.

Layer 3: The Cost, the Law, and the Leverage

Finally, document the case. Do the **water and energy figures** show an unacceptable cost? Does the **law** — environmental, water, planning — give a handle? Is the **benefit** genuinely thin? And where is the **leverage** — the commune, the regulators, the courts, the public? Each is a separate ground, and together they make a case that is hard to wave away, even by a government that favours the investment. This is the layer that most often decides these fights, because here an enormous, provable water-and-energy cost, a thin benefit, a hidden set of figures, and a legal or planning handle are joined — exactly the case that quashed permits and shrank projects abroad, and that keeps Bissen contested. Build it well, and the company's secrecy becomes its weakness. One practical note on building this layer: distinguish rigorously between what you have established and what you have estimated, and label each honestly in the file. Against a well-resourced company, your credibility is the one asset it cannot outspend, and a single overstated figure can be used to discredit an otherwise sound case. Where the company hides the true numbers and you must estimate, say so plainly, show your method, and rely on the environmental movement and independent experts to stand behind the estimate. A conservative figure you can defend is worth more than a dramatic one you cannot. The same discipline applies to how you describe the company and the government: accurately, and without insult. Calling a company secretive when it has refused to disclose is fair and documented; calling it evil is neither, and it hands your opponents the easy rebuttal that the community is unreasonable. Describe the government's preference for the investment as exactly that, not as a conspiracy, unless you have evidence of one. Precision and fairness are not weakness; they are what make a community impossible to caricature, and against a company that will try to paint you as fringe, being visibly reasonable is a strategic weapon. The company will look for any error to seize on; give it none, and let the provable water-and-energy cost, stated precisely, do the work.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists. Here is where the material tends to live in a Luxembourg data-centre or heavy-development fight, and how to get it — with the **water and energy figures and the company's secrecy** at the center. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

The Project and Permit Record

Start with the project itself. The **land it needs and any reclassification** — from farmland to industrial, as at Bissen — is a matter of communal record and can be tracked and challenged. **Permits and authorisations** — environmental, water, construction — leave a paper trail with the authorities. Establish exactly **what the project is, what it needs, and where in the approval path it stands**, because a project not yet permitted is a project that can still be stopped, and a reclassification not yet final is one that can still be fought.

The Water and Energy Evidence

This is the heart of the file. Gather every available figure and expert estimate for the project's **water consumption** and its **share of the local and national supply**; its **energy demand** and its **share of the grid and of national household use**; and the **method of cooling** (water-hungry cooling is the vulnerability that lost these projects abroad). Where the company **refuses to disclose**, document the refusal and commission independent estimates, as analysts did at Bissen. The environmental movement, academic

experts, and technical institutes can supply or check these numbers. A large, provable water-and-energy cost is the single most powerful thing this file can contain.

The Benefit and the Secrecy

Document what the project actually gives, because a thin benefit is half the argument. Establish the **real jobs** (data centres famously create few), the **tax** the structure will actually yield, and any **other genuine value** — scientific, economic — against the risks. And document the **company's secrecy**: every refusal to publish water and energy data, every claim of confidentiality the government endorses. At Bissen, the combination of a few jobs, little tax, no scientific contribution, and a company that would not share its figures was the case. Thin benefit and hidden numbers, set against an enormous water-and-energy cost, are hard for any government to defend.

The Legal and Planning Handles

Identify the levers the law and the process give. **National and EU environmental, water, and energy law** set standards a project must meet, and a permit that ignores them can be quashed, as a court quashed one abroad over water. The **planning and reclassification process** at the commune is a veto point. **Environmental impact and consultation requirements** create both information and a challenge. Map which apply and where the project is vulnerable, ideally with an environmental lawyer, because a data centre that fails a water, energy, or environmental standard, or a reclassification that can be refused, is where these fights are often won or delayed.

The People and the Allies

Finally, map the human terrain. Who is affected — the commune, the farmers, the water users? Who are the **community groups** already organising, as Bissen's were? Who are the **experts, the environmental movement, the sympathetic officials, and the commune's own politicians**? A data-centre fight is won by a community joined to expertise, the environmental movement, and a commune willing to say no — so map your coalition as deliberately as your evidence. A word on the particular allies a data-centre fight offers, because they are distinctive. The environmental movement brings both the technical capacity to estimate the water and energy the company hides and a ready public voice. Academic and technical experts can turn vague fears into hard, defensible figures — the single most valuable thing a data-centre file can contain. The commune's own politicians can be allies rather than adversaries, because a reclassification or permit their council controls is a real veto, and local politics can diverge from national preference. And communities facing the same projects elsewhere, at home and abroad, are allies of a special kind: their experience is a map, their wins are your evidence, and their solidarity links your local stand to a global movement that is winning. Reach to all of them deliberately, because a data-centre fight is won by a community joined to expertise, to the environmental movement, to the commune, and to a wider movement — not by a community alone.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Evidence does not move deciders by itself. A community — organised, informed, and joined to the environmental movement and the commune — is what turns the water-and-energy cost and the transparency demand into pressure a government that favours the investment cannot ignore. Bissen proved a community will act; the task is to organise that will into force.

Why the Community Is Decisive

A regulator can dismiss an individual complaint; an organised commune and public are harder to wave away. The community supplies what a campaign runs on: the affected voices, the local knowledge, the water users and farmers, the volunteers, the pressure on the commune, and the legitimacy that makes a case a cause. When a community stands together — as Bissen's groups did, and as the communities that beat these projects abroad did — a government's preference for the investment meets a real political cost. **A united community is not the backdrop to the campaign; it is the campaign's engine. This is worth dwelling on, because it is where many communities misjudge their own strength. Facing a global company and a government that wants the investment, people assume they are powerless, and that assumption defeats them before the fight begins. But a data centre is unusually vulnerable to an organised public, precisely because its costs — the water, the power, the land — are shared by everyone on the supply and grid, while its benefits are thin and concentrated. That asymmetry is the community's advantage: nearly everyone has a stake in the water and the power, and almost no one has a stake in the company's few jobs. An organised community makes that shared stake visible and turns it into a political fact the deciders must reckon with. The company has money and the government's ear; the community has numbers, legitimacy, and the truth about the water and the power. Organised, that is a match for a great deal.**

Finding the Affected Community

Begin with those the project touches most — the **commune's residents, the water users, the farmers whose land is taken or reclassified**, as a Bissen farmer was pressed to sell. Widen to everyone who shares the water and the grid and who will bear the cost for little benefit — which, with a data centre taking a nation's water and power, is nearly everyone. Name the shared stake — **our water, our power, our land, for their few jobs** — because that is what turns scattered residents into a movement. The framing matters. A fight cast narrowly — as one commune's objection, or one farmer's grievance — is easy to isolate and dismiss. A fight cast as a defence of the nation's shared water and power against a foreign giant that gives little and hides much is one that everyone on the supply can join. Do not let the project be framed as a local nuisance to be managed; frame it as a question about what the country's water and power are worth, and who gets to decide. That larger frame is both truer and stronger, and it is the frame under which these projects have been beaten elsewhere. The water and the power belong to everyone, and everyone can be asked to help defend them. This is also the answer to the objection you will hear early and often: that the investment means jobs and progress, and that opposing it is backward or selfish. Meet it head-on and on the facts. A data centre is not a factory; it creates strikingly few permanent jobs, and it is precisely the mismatch between its enormous consumption of shared water and power and its thin, concentrated benefit that makes the community's case strong. Opposing a project that takes a tenth of a nation's water for fifty jobs is not backwardness; it is arithmetic. Frame the community not as anti-progress but as pro-accountability — asking, reasonably, what the project will really cost in water and power, who will bear that cost, and what the public will truly get in return. That is a case fair-minded people join, and one the company's slogans cannot easily answer.

Coalition-Building

A community allied is stronger than a community alone. Reach deliberately to the **environmental movement**, which at Bissen led on the water and energy case; **technical and academic experts** who can pin down the figures; **the commune and its politicians**, a real veto point; **water users and farmers**; **other communities** facing data centres, at home and abroad, whose experience and solidarity are real; and the **national and international networks** now tracking data centres' water and energy use. Breadth signals that this is not a fringe objection but a shared defence of the nation's water, power, and land.

Sustaining Momentum

Campaigns against a courted investment can be long — Bissen has run for years and is not resolved. Sustain the community with **transparency, small wins, and shared purpose**. Mark each step — a figure forced into the open, a transparency demand met, a commune vote, a legal question filed, a media story — because a data-centre fight can be a marathon against a patient company and a willing government, and a community that sees progress endures. The community that lasts is the one that stays informed, sees its wins, and keeps its eyes on the water, the power, and the land it is defending. Sustaining a long campaign is its own discipline, distinct from winning any single battle. A data-centre fight against a courted investment is rarely decided quickly; it moves through reclassifications, permits, consultations, and possible litigation, over months and often years, and the company counts on the community tiring. Guard against that. Rotate the load so no one burns out; keep the meetings purposeful and the information flowing; and above all, mark the interim gains — a figure prised into the open, a transparency demand answered, a commune vote survived, a media story landed — because these are the proof that the fight is alive and worth continuing. A community that measures itself only against the final outcome will despair in a long fight; one that counts its steps endures. The marathon rewards the organised, and endurance is itself a form of pressure the company does not control. There is a second reason endurance matters, particular to these projects: a data centre's economics and plans shift over time, and a fight that stays alive is positioned to seize those shifts. Companies revise designs, reconsider sites, and respond to costs and public mood; a community still organised when that happens can turn a wobble into a win, while one that dispersed cannot. The delays a long campaign imposes are not merely time bought — they are opportunities created, because every month a project is contested is a month in which its business case can weaken, its investors can cool, and a better argument or a new ally can appear. This is not a reason to prolong a fight for its own sake, but a reason not to give up when the outcome is slow: in these particular fights, patience and organisation are strategic assets, not just virtues. Hold, too, a realistic picture of what patience is up against, so it does not curdle into false hope: the company is patient as well, and better resourced, and the government's preference does not evaporate on its own. Patience wins only when it is organised patience — a community that stays informed, keeps its coalition warm, and remains ready to act at each decision point. Idle waiting loses; active, prepared endurance is what turns the long timeline from the company's advantage into the community's.

STEP 4: LEGAL & REGULATORY CHALLENGES — WATER, ENERGY, AND THE PLANNING PROCESS

Legal and regulatory action is where a data-centre fight is often delayed, shrunk, or won, because the project's enormous water and energy demands must clear real legal standards, and the reclassification and permits it needs can be fought — as a court quashed a permit over water abroad, and as the reclassification was contested at Bissen. Used well, the law and the planning process are among the most powerful levers a Luxembourg community has, even against a government that favours the investment.

Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth, and here it is central. The law and the process are **real but not automatic**. The government **favours the investment**; the land at Bissen is **already reclassified**; and a company will **litigate and delay**. A legal or planning challenge can **quash a permit, force disclosure, delay a project, or win concessions** — as challenges did abroad — but it may not, by itself, deliver a clean stop against a determined government. Enter it clear-eyed: as one powerful lever among five, strongest when the **water and energy cost is large and provable and the public is mobilised behind it** — not as a guaranteed victory. Bissen's own legal and planning fights have delayed and contested the project without yet stopping

it. It is worth being precise about what legal and regulatory action realistically achieves against a courted data centre, because both over-promising and dismissing it are mistakes. Realistically, this front delivers four things. It can quash a specific permit or authorisation that broke the law — the cleanest win, and the one a court delivered abroad over a project's water. It can force disclosure of the water and energy figures a company would rather hide, through information rights. It can delay a project, sometimes for years, buying the time the wider campaign needs and raising the company's costs and doubts. And it can win concessions — a smaller footprint, a different cooling method, real conditions — that reshape a project even where they do not stop it. What it rarely does, alone, is deliver a clean, final stop against a determined government. Used as one lever among five, tied to the water-and-energy exposure and a mobilised public, it is powerful; used alone, as a hoped-for silver bullet, it disappoints. Enter it for what it reliably gives — a quashed permit, forced disclosure, delay, concessions — and let the other four levers do the rest.

The Water, Energy, and Environmental Law

The first legal front is the project's environmental cost. **National and EU environmental, water, and energy law** set standards a data centre must meet — on water abstraction, on environmental impact, on energy. A permit or authorisation that **ignored the water cost, skipped or botched an environmental assessment, or failed a legal standard can be challenged and quashed**, exactly as a court abroad quashed a data centre's authorisation over its failure to account properly for water. An environmental lawyer and the environmental movement can identify where the project is legally vulnerable, and the water-hungry cooling that lost these projects elsewhere is often the vulnerability.

The Planning and Reclassification Process

The second front is land use. A data centre needs **land reclassified and permitted at the commune**, and that process is a veto point and a place to challenge. A **reclassification from farmland to industrial can be contested**; a **communal permit can be refused**; the **consultation and impact requirements** create both information and grounds for challenge. At Bissen, the reclassification of farmland was central, and abroad, town after town simply refused the rezoning a data centre needed. The commune, its council, and the planning process are where a determined local politics can stop or stall a project the national government wants.

The Transparency and Information Front

The third front is disclosure, and it is distinctive here. A community can use **access-to-information and environmental-information rights** to force the water and energy figures the company hides into the open, as campaigners abroad went to court to learn a project's true water use. A company's **secrecy is both a target and a weapon** — the refusal itself, challenged, becomes evidence of a project that will not stand scrutiny. Forcing transparency is often the step that unlocks the rest, because once the true water and energy cost is public, the environmental, planning, and public fronts all gain their ammunition. This is why transparency is the lever to reach for first when a project is moving. Everything else in the campaign depends on the figures: the environmental challenge needs the water abstraction numbers, the commune needs to know what its consent would cost, the media needs the stark comparison, and the public needs to understand the stake. A company that refuses to disclose is, in effect, betting that no one will force the question — and information rights, national and European, are how you call that bet. When the figures come out, one of two things happens: either they confirm the community's worst fears, and the case makes itself, or the company's continued refusal becomes the story, an admission by silence that the project cannot bear scrutiny. Either way the community gains. Force the figures early, and the rest of the campaign has its ammunition. There is also a strategic sequencing point worth naming. Because disclosure feeds everything,

a smart campaign often opens on the transparency front even before its coalition is fully built, because the information request is cheap, fast, and does not require numbers. Filing early does two useful things: it starts the clock on a process the company cannot control, and it establishes, on the record, that the community asked and what the company did in response. If the figures come, you have your ammunition; if they do not, you have documented a refusal that will serve you later before the commune, the court, and the press. Few opening moves cost so little and yield so much, which is why forcing transparency belongs near the very start of the campaign.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each decider in the language that moves them. The same water-and-energy file becomes different arguments for a regulator, a court, a commune, a journalist, and the public. Translate deliberately.

For the Environmental and Water Regulators

Regulators respond to **standards, water, and law**. Frame the project's harm as a breach or a failure: the water abstraction that threatens the supply, the environmental assessment that was skipped or botched, the energy demand the grid cannot bear, the legal standard unmet. Give them the water and energy figures and the legal ground to demand better or refuse. Make it easy to act and costly to wave through: *here is the water cost, here is the standard, here is the law*.

For the Courts

Courts respond to **law and procedure**. Frame the harm as a legal failure: a permit that ignored the water cost, an assessment that was inadequate, a right to information denied, a reclassification that broke the rules. A court quashed a data centre's authorisation abroad over exactly such a failure. Precise, procedural, and evidenced arguments are what win here — the water-and-energy file translated into legal grounds.

For the Commune

The commune responds to **its residents, its land, and its politics**. Frame the project as a bad bargain for the community: a nation's water and power taken for a handful of jobs, farmland lost, little tax, real risk. Give the councillors the cost, the thin benefit, and the organised public behind a refusal. Abroad, communes and councils refused these projects outright; the argument that wins them is *this takes much and gives little, and your community is against it*.

For the Media and the Public

The press and the public respond to **stakes, fairness, and clarity**. Translate the water-and-energy file into a story anyone can grasp: a giant foreign company wants a tenth of our water and as much power as every home, for a few jobs, and won't even tell us the figures — and a community said no. The secrecy, the water, the thin benefit, the David-and-Goliath shape — these are what make a data-centre fight a national and international cause, as they have elsewhere.

The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate. Your credibility is your greatest asset, and against a well-resourced company it will be tested. State the water and energy figures precisely, distinguish estimate from established fact, and be honest — including that the fight may be long and its outcome, as at Bissen, open. A community that is precise and honest, especially about the water and the power, is far harder to dismiss than one that

overreaches.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and public attention convert your evidence into pressure the deciders feel, and here the story — a nation's water and power taken for little, in secret, by a foreign giant — is one that travels, at home and around the world.

Why Media Matters

A regulator, a commune, or a government weighing an investment behaves differently when the public and the world are watching. Media does three things: it **informs and mobilises the public**, it **raises the political cost** of favouring the company, and it **draws the national and international attention** that data centres' water and energy use now command. At Bissen the water and energy figures and the company's secrecy became the story; abroad, media pressure helped force projects to pause, shrink, and withdraw. A fight kept public is a fight with the wind at its back.

Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the water, the power, and the secrecy. The strongest frame is concrete and fair: *a giant foreign company wants a huge share of our water and power for a handful of jobs, won't disclose the figures, and our community is defending what's ours*. Put the human and the national stake first — the water, the land, the farmer pressed to sell, the commune — and let the numbers follow. Keep it accurate; a story that overreaches on the figures hands the company its rebuttal. The data-centre story is powerful precisely because the water and energy cost is real and the secrecy is indefensible.

Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience. **National press** for reach and legitimacy; **local media** for the commune and the affected residents; **the environmental movement's channels** for the mobilised base; **social media** for speed and the public; and — distinctively here — **the international networks and press tracking data centres' water and energy use**, whose attention has helped these fights elsewhere and links yours to a global movement that is winning. A data-centre fight is naturally an international story; use that.

A Few Cautions

Stay accurate and fair, especially on the numbers and toward the company and the government — the goal is a credible public case, not exaggeration, and evenhandedness is both right and effective. Protect the community; keep private individuals, and anyone pressed or vulnerable, out of the glare unless they choose it. And sustain it: a data-centre fight can be long, so pace the story — a figure forced into the open, a transparency win, a commune vote, a legal step — to keep attention alive across a marathon against a patient company.

EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real project, the real water and energy figures, and the real facts, keep it factual, and never overstate. Here honesty and precision on the numbers matter more than force.

8A: Requesting Information from the Authorities

Subject: Request for information — [project name], water, energy, and permits

Dear [official],

I am writing on behalf of [community/group] regarding [project] at [location]. To participate meaningfully in the decisions affecting our community, we request the following: the project's **water consumption and its source**; its **energy demand**; the **environmental assessments and permits** applied for or granted; and the **reclassification** of the land. Please advise how to obtain these under the applicable access-to-information rules.

We would be grateful for a response by [date].

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8B: Demanding the Water and Energy Figures

Subject: Request for disclosure — water and energy use of [project]

Dear [company/authority],

Our community shares the water and power that [project] would consume. We therefore ask [company/authority] to disclose the project's **water consumption** (and its share of local supply), its **cooling method**, and its **energy demand** (and its share of the grid). Where these have not been made public, we ask that they be published so the community and the authorities can assess the project on the facts.

A project of this scale should be able to state plainly what water and power it will use.

Sincerely,

[Name, community, contact]

8C: Letter to the Commune

Subject: [Project] — a poor bargain for our community

Dear [councillor/mayor and council],

We write regarding [project], which requires [reclassification/permit] from this commune. On the figures available, the project would consume [water figure] of our water and [energy figure] of our power, while providing only [jobs/tax], and the company has [declined to disclose key figures]. We ask the council to weigh this bargain carefully, to demand full disclosure of the water and energy cost, and to [refuse/defer] the [reclassification/permit] until the community's water, power, and land are protected.

Our community stands ready to support you in defending them.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8D: Letter to an Environmental Lawyer

Subject: Request for advice — [project], water and planning

Dear [name],

Our community opposes [project] at [location], a data centre/development that would consume a major share of our water and power. We seek advice on possible legal and planning grounds: whether the **environmental or water permits** are challengeable; whether the **reclassification** can be contested; and whether **access-to-information** rights can compel disclosure of the water and energy figures. We can provide our documentation. Please advise on grounds, process, timeline, and cost.

With thanks,

[Name, community, contact]

8E: Media Pitch

Subject: A foreign giant wants our water and power — and won't say how much

Dear [journalist],

At [location], [company] plans a data centre that could take [water figure] of the nation's water and as much power as [energy figure] — for [few jobs] and little tax — while refusing to disclose its figures. Our community is defending its water, power, and land. There is a clear story here — the water, the secrecy, the thin benefit, the community's stand — and we can provide documentation, figures, and voices.

May we send a briefing?

Sincerely,

[Name, community, contact]

8F: Coalition Outreach

Subject: Join us in defending our water and power

Dear [organisation],

We are [group], opposing [project], a data centre/development that threatens our community's water, power, and land. Your [expertise/voice/experience] would strengthen our defence, and the water and energy stakes are shared by everyone on our supply and grid — and by communities facing the same projects elsewhere. May we discuss how we might work together?

In solidarity,

[Name, community, contact]

8G: Letter to a Sympathetic Official

Subject: Standing with our community on [project]

Dear [official],

Our community is deeply concerned about [project], which would consume a major share of our water and power for little benefit, with key figures undisclosed. We know you care about [water/environment/community], and we ask your support: to press for full disclosure of the water and energy cost, to ensure the law and the planning process are properly applied, and to stand with the community. We would welcome the chance to brief you.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8H: Rallying the Community

Subject: Our water, our power, our land — let us defend them

Dear neighbours,

[Project] would take a major share of our water and power for a handful of jobs, and the company will not even tell us the figures. But communities like ours — here and around the world — have defended their water and power and made these companies answer, and some have sent them away. Please join us: come to [meeting], sign [petition], and add your voice. Together we can insist that our water, our power, and our land are not given away in secret.

With determination,

[Name, community group]

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Sometimes a project is moving fast — a reclassification vote, a permit near approval — and you cannot run the full campaign. Triage to the levers that move fastest, and here that means the water and energy exposure and the transparency demand.

The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials: **what the project is, what water and power it will take, where it stands in the approval path, and who decides**. Identify the immediate pressure point — a **commune vote, a permit, a consultation deadline** — because that is what you must affect first. Find whether **community groups and the environmental movement** are already organising; if so, join them rather than starting anew, as Bissen's groups offer a ready coalition.

The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **Exposing the water and energy cost** — a stark, provable figure — can shift a debate in days. **A transparency demand** — asking the figures the company hides — puts the company on the back foot quickly. **A media story** — the water, the secrecy, the thin benefit — can travel fast. **Pressure on the commune** before a vote is immediate. **A legal or information request** can force disclosure or delay. These outpace the slower work of a full legal case, though that may follow.

Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a broad coalition overnight, but you can activate a fast one. Reach immediately to the **environmental movement, existing community groups, sympathetic commune politicians, and any expert who can speak to the water and energy cost**. A handful of credible voices raising the water, the power, and the secrecy at the right moment — before a vote, in the press — can buy the time the fuller campaign needs. Speed favours the prepared: know your figures, your pressure point, and your allies before the deadline. And if you are caught genuinely flat-footed, with a vote days away and little prepared, concentrate everything on the two levers that move fastest and cost least: a stark, defensible statement of the water and power the project will take, and a public demand for the figures the company has not disclosed. Those two, aimed at the commune's councillors and the local press before the decision, can shift a vote or force a deferral that buys the time to build the rest. Do not try to run the whole campaign in a week; run the two fastest levers hard, win the delay, and then build. A deferral is not a defeat — it is the time in which real campaigns are made. And use that time deliberately: in the days after a deferral, convert the

attention you generated into structure — collect the contacts of everyone who showed up, line up the expert who can firm the figures, brief the sympathetic councillors properly, and file the information request you had not yet filed. A deferral won and then squandered leaves you back where you started when the decision returns; a deferral won and used leaves you far stronger. The scramble that won the delay must give way immediately to the organising that wins the fight.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Sometimes you do everything right and still face a wall — not because your case is weak, but because the government wants the investment. This is Luxembourg's hardest honest truth for these fights, and Bissen embodies it: the government has favoured the company. Name it plainly, because pretending the field is level wastes effort and hope.

Recognising a Tilted Field

The signs are specific. The **government publicly backs the project** and courts the investment. The **land is reclassified and a farmer pressed to sell** before the community can mount a defence. The **company's secrecy is endorsed** rather than challenged by officials. Decisions favour the project despite the water and energy cost. When the state is on the company's side, the ordinary levers — a regulator's scrutiny, a fair process — may be blunted, and you must widen the fight.

Strategies for a Tilted Field

When the field tilts, change the game. Shift weight to the levers the government controls least: the **courts** (a permit quashed on law, as abroad); the **commune** (a local politics that can still refuse); **transparency** (forcing the hidden figures into the open); the **public** (raising the political cost of favouring the company); and **international attention** (linking your fight to a global movement that is winning against these projects). Make the water and energy cost and the secrecy so public that backing the company carries a price. Build the record even when you cannot yet win, because a documented, well-argued, public case — as at Bissen — keeps the project contested, forces delay and concession, and lays the ground for a later win. A tilted field lengthens the odds; it does not end the fight, and communities have won these against willing governments before.

The Honest Possibility of Losing

You may lose, and this guide will not pretend otherwise — especially here, where the leading local fight is not won. The project may be built despite everything. If that comes, the work is still not wasted: the **water and energy cost was exposed, transparency was forced, the record was made, the community was organised, and the next fight — yours or another community's — starts stronger**. Bissen's opponents have not stopped the project, but they have forced disclosure, delay, and a national argument about what the country's water and power are worth. Sit with that honestly, because it is the realistic middle ground most of these fights occupy, between the clean wins abroad and outright defeat. A community can lose the final decision and still have changed a great deal: the terms of the debate, the public's understanding of what data centres cost, the willingness of the next commune to demand disclosure, the precedent that a project cannot simply arrive in secret and take a nation's water. Movements are built from such partial results. The communities that eventually win the clean victories are often standing on the documented, organised groundwork of those who came before and did not, quite, prevail. If your fight ends in that middle ground — disclosure forced, delay imposed, the argument won even as the project proceeds — you will have done real work, and handed the next community a stronger starting point than you had. That is not victory, but it is not

nothing, and it is how movements that eventually win are built. Fight to win; if you lose, lose in a way that strengthens the next stand. This is not consolation dressed as strategy; it is a real description of how these fights are won over time. The clean victories communities have secured against data centres elsewhere did not appear from nowhere; they were built on years of communities before them exposing the water costs, forcing the disclosures, and losing decisions while winning arguments, until the argument had shifted enough that a court, a council, or a company finally moved. A fight waged well and documented honestly is never wholly lost, because it changes the ground on which the next fight is waged. Keep that longer horizon in view, especially in the hard middle where the outcome is slow and uncertain, because it is the truest answer to despair: your stand, even unfinished, is part of how the movement wins.

WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO IS CAPTURED

Sometimes a project advances not merely because the government favours investment, but because the process itself is captured — decisions made for the company's benefit against the public interest, transparency refused, scrutiny suppressed. Distinguish this carefully from ordinary political preference, because the response differs and the accusation is grave.

Telling Capture from Ordinary Politics

A government preferring investment, even wrongly, is politics, not corruption. Capture shows different marks: **figures hidden without lawful basis and secrecy officially endorsed**; **process bent** — reclassifications rushed, assessments skipped, consultation denied; **scrutiny suppressed** rather than answered. Be rigorous: distinguish a bad decision from a corrupt one, and do not cry corruption where there is only a preference you oppose. But where the marks of capture are real, name them, because they change the fight. The distinction is not merely semantic; it determines your strategy. If the problem is ordinary political preference — a government that simply wants the investment — your work is to raise the political and legal cost of that preference until it is no longer worth paying: the public, the courts, the commune, the international attention. If the problem is genuine capture — a process bent and secrecy unlawfully endorsed — your work shifts toward the institutions capture cannot easily reach: the independent courts, the audit and oversight bodies, the investigative press, and the European level above the captured national one. Misdiagnosing the problem wastes effort, so judge it carefully and honestly. But in either case the response routes around the obstacle to the levers still open, and in both, the water-and-energy exposure and the forced transparency remain the community's sharpest tools.

Responding to Capture

Capture calls for a wider arsenal, deployed carefully. Push the fight to the levers capture controls least: the **courts** and the **rule of law**; the **transparency and information rights** that force hidden figures open; **independent oversight and audit**; the **press** and **investigative journalism**; and **EU-level and international scrutiny**, which a captured national process cannot easily suppress. Document everything meticulously and lawfully, because in a captured process the record is both shield and weapon. Protect those who speak, and rely on institutions and collective action rather than individual exposure. The aim is to route around the capture to the levers still open, and to make the hidden visible.

A Note on Safety and Care

Luxembourg is a stable, rule-of-law democracy, and the risks here are far lower than in many places — this is, honestly, a fight waged mainly in meetings, filings, and the press, not one of physical danger. Still, exercise judgment. Keep the campaign **lawful, documented, and collective**. Protect private individuals —

the farmer pressed to sell, any vulnerable resident — from unwanted exposure. Prefer institutional and legal channels, which here are real and effective. And sustain the community for a long fight, because against a courted investment the marathon, not the sprint, is the likely shape. Care for the people is part of winning.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others. Here is how they fit into a single campaign against a data centre or heavy development in Luxembourg.

The Parallel Campaign

From the start, the five run together. **Documentation** builds the water, energy, and benefit file. **Target identification** aims it at the deciders. **Local opposition** organises the community and coalition. **Legal and regulatory** work presses the courts, regulators, and commune. **Media** makes it a national and international cause. The water-and-energy exposure and the transparency demand feed all five at once — a forced figure is evidence, a media story, and public pressure together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall. The compounding is the whole point. Consider how a single forced disclosure travels across all five fronts at once: the water figure that an information request prises loose is, in the same week, evidence for a legal challenge, a headline for the press, a fact the commune's councillors can no longer ignore, and a rallying number for the public. A community running the fronts separately would have to win each of those five times over; a community running them together wins them once and lets the result ripple. This is why the guide insists on parallel operation rather than a tidy sequence. You do not finish documentation and then begin organising; you organise around the documentation as it grows, and press the law and the media and the commune with each new fact. The campaign is not a relay in which one runner hands off to the next, but a chorus in which every voice sounds at once, and the water-and-energy exposure is the note they all hold.

A Rough Timeline

Early (weeks 1–6): establish the project, the water and energy cost, and the deciders; find or join the community groups; begin the transparency demands and the documentation. **Middle (months 2–8):** build the coalition and the case; force the figures open; press the commune and the regulators; make it a media story; file legal or information challenges. **Later (months 6+):** sustain the pressure across the approval path — a reclassification vote, a permit, a court question — adjusting as the project moves. A data-centre fight, as Bissen shows, can run for years; pace the campaign for the marathon. A practical way to pace it is to organise the campaign around the project's own decision points rather than the calendar. Each reclassification, permit, consultation, or possible court date is a moment when the project is vulnerable and public attention can be focused; the stretches between them are for building — gathering figures, growing the coalition, preparing the next challenge. Plan the visible pushes for the decision points, where they land hardest, and use the quieter periods to prepare rather than to strain. A campaign that spends all its energy continuously will exhaust itself before the decisions that matter; one that builds quietly and strikes at the vulnerable moments conserves its strength for when it counts.

The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that wins these fights: **expose the true water and energy cost; force the transparency the company refuses; argue the thin benefit; use the law and the commune; mobilise the public — and keep every claim precise and honest.** The community that presses all five, grounded in real figures, joined to the environmental movement and the commune, and prepared for a long and

uncertain fight, is the one that delays, shrinks, reshapes, and sometimes stops a project — as communities have done against these very data centres elsewhere, and as Bissen's opponents are attempting still. It helps to hold the concrete examples in mind, because they are the proof the discipline works, and they map onto the levers this guide teaches. Abroad, a community's opposition and a court's ruling over a project's failure to account for its water forced a global company to pause a data centre and restart the design without water-hungry cooling. In another country, campaigners used the courts to prise open what a project would really take — millions of gallons of drinking water a day from a strained supply — and the disclosure forced the project to shrink and abandon water cooling. In yet another, town after town, weighing the water and power against a handful of jobs, simply refused the rezoning the project needed and sent the company away. Each of those is a lever in this guide made real: the environmental and water law, the transparency demand, the thin-benefit argument, the planning veto, the mobilised public. None required a community more powerful than yours; each required a community that pressed the levers together and refused to assume defeat.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Stopping a destructive development in Luxembourg is genuinely possible, and the fight of this decade — a community against a water-and-power-hungry data centre — shows both how, and, honestly, how hard, and how uncertain. The task is not to find a single silver bullet but to press every lever together: the water and energy exposure, the transparency demand, the thin benefit, the law, the commune, and the public.

Some honest truths hold across every campaign here. **The water and energy cost is the killer argument, and forcing transparency is the distinctive weapon. The law, the commune, and the public are real levers. But the government often favours the investment, the company will fight, and — as at Bissen — the outcome can stay open for years.** Hold both truths at once: real power, real limits.

Above all, keep the discipline that gives these fights their strength. Build the water-and-energy file. Force the hidden figures open. Argue the thin benefit plainly. Use the courts, the regulators, and the commune. Mobilise the public and the world. And be honest — including about the odds, and about a leading fight not yet won — because a precise, honest community defending its water, its power, and its land is far harder to defeat than a company hoping no one asks what it will really take.

The Bissen fight is not won. But communities elsewhere, facing the same projects from the same kind of companies, have forced them to restart without water cooling, shrunk them, and sent them away — and Bissen's own opponents have forced disclosure, delay, and a national reckoning over what the country's water and power are worth. The tools are real, the movement is global and winning, and the levers in this guide are the ones that beat these projects. Your community's water, power, and land are worth defending, the odds are better than "nothing can be done," and the fight — even unfinished — is one worth waging. Communities elsewhere have won it. So can yours. And they won it not because they were powerful, but because they were organised, precise, and unwilling to assume that a giant company and a willing government had already settled the matter. They asked what the water and the power were worth, forced the figures into the open, argued the thin benefit plainly, used the law and the commune, and refused to be caricatured or worn down. Those tools are available to any community, including yours. Pick them up, use them together, and hold on: the water, the power, and the land you are defending are worth exactly that much effort, and the fight is far from hopeless.